

Boyd C. Ruamcharoen

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Academic Appointments

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA 2025–27
Postdoctoral Fellow in Global American Studies
Charles Warren Center for Studies in American History

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA 2025
Ph.D. in History, Anthropology, and Science, Technology, and Society (HASTS)
Swarthmore College, Swarthmore, PA 2015
B.A. in Sociology and Anthropology, with a Minor in Interpretation Theory

Publications

Book Project

Empire of Rot: Weatherable Materials, U.S. Power, and Postcolonial Worldmaking (in preparation).

Peer-Reviewed Articles

“Rotten Analogies: Climatic Analogs and the U.S. Military’s Management of Tropical Decay from World War II to the Vietnam War,” *Environment and Planning E: Nature and Space*, special issue on “Militarized Landscapes” (forthcoming).
“Tropicalizing the Portable Radio: Electronics and the U.S. Military’s Battle Against Fungi in the Pacific War,” *Technology and Culture* 65, no. 2 (2024): 497–529.

Selected Awards and Honors

Awards

Edward M. Coffman First-Manuscript Prize, Honorable Mention 2026
Society for Military History (SMH), for the best dissertation in military history
Bernard S. Finn IEEE History Prize (for “Tropicalizing the Portable Radio”) 2025
Society for the History of Technology (SHOT), for the best published paper in the history of electrotechnology

Grants and Fellowships

William Appleman Williams Emerging Scholar Grant 2026
Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR)
Taylor-Wei Dissertation Fellowship in the History of Meteorology 2024–25
Department of History of Science, Technology, and Medicine, University of Oklahoma

Lemelson Center for the Study of Invention and Innovation Fellowship National Museum of American History (NMAH), Smithsonian Institution	2023
Samuel Flaggs Bemis Dissertation Research Grant Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR)	2023
Henry Belin du Pont Fellowship Hagley Museum and Library	2022
Research Fellowship Consortium for History of Science, Technology, and Medicine (CHSTM)	2022

Selected Talks and Presentations

“Environmentalism in Decay: Microbial Decomposition and the Politics of Recycling from Ecology to Resource Recovery, 1960s–70s,” Metabolic Frontiers, European Society for the History of Science (ESHS) and History of Science Society (HSS) Joint Meeting, Edinburgh, Scotland, July 13–16	2026
“Building a Weatherable Empire,” Infrastructures of Global American Power, Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR) Annual Meeting, Columbus, OH, June 25–27	2026
“Environmentalism in Decay: Biodegradable Materials and the U.S. Empire’s Science of Durability, 1960s–70s,” Technological Environmentalisms, American Society for Environmental History (ASEH) Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO, March 25–28	2026
“Weathering Decolonization: Tropical Standards of Durability and Postcolonial Worldmaking, 1947–1970s,” Building the Non-Aligned World, Society for the History of Technology (SHOT) Annual Meeting, Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxembourg, October 9–11	2025
“Weathering Decolonization: Weatherable Materials and the Making of Tropical Futures,” The Environment and Worldmaking, Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR) Annual Meeting, Arlington, VA, June 26–28	2025
Roundtable Participant, Envirotech Roundtable: Past, Present, and Future Directions, American Society of Environmental History (ASEH) Annual Meeting, Pittsburgh, PA, April 9–13	2025
Roundtable Participant, The Habitat of Empire: How U.S. Power Shaped the Environment and Vice Versa, Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR) Annual Meeting, Toronto, Canada, June 13–15	2024
“Deteriorating Relations: The Deterioration of Materials and U.S. Global Environmental Management,” Pathologies of Materials, American Society for Environmental History (ASEH) Annual Meeting, Denver, CO, April 3–7	2024
“Archive Fever After Empire: Microfilm, American Archivists, and the Postcolonial Tropics, 1945–72,” U.S. Foreign Relations in Extreme Environments, Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR) Annual Meeting, Arlington, VA, June 15–17	2023
“The Decomposing Message: Electronics, Tropical Deterioration, and the United States in World War II,” Emerging Scholars Workshop: New Directions in WWII History, The Jenny Craig Institute for the Study of War and Democracy at the National WWII Museum, New Orleans, LA, February 23–24	2023

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

Ecologies of American Empire, 1898–2000 Department of History, Harvard University	Spring 2026
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Teaching Assistant

Cultures of Computing Program in Science, Technology, and Society (STS), MIT	Spring 2023
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The Indigenous History of MIT History Section, MIT	Fall 2021
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Technology and Culture Anthropology Program, MIT	Fall 2020
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Science in Action: Technologies and Controversies in Everyday Life Program in Science, Technology, and Society (STS), MIT	Spring 2020
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Pedagogical Training

Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program (KTCP) Teaching and Learning Lab (TLL), MIT	2024
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Service

Professional Service

Co-convener, Envirotech Special Interest Group (SIG), American Society for Environmental History (ASEH) and the Society for the History of Technology (SHOT)	2025–
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Co-founder and Editor, ContraSTS Magazine	2024–
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Institutional Service

Student Representative, History Section, MIT	2024–25
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Student Coordinator, Seminar on Environmental and Agricultural History (SEAH), MIT	2022–24
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Programmer and Organizer, Cross-STS Seminar Series, MIT	2022
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